



DIVEKOMODO

DIVEMASTER



DIVEKOMODO

HELLO AND WELCOME TO DIVEKOMODO

Thank you for your interest in becoming a PADI Divemaster with us!

Choosing where to do your DM course is a big decision. It's not only the location that matters, but finding a suitable dive shop where you feel welcome and comfortable is also important. We hope that this information package will help you to paint the picture of what to expect from the Divemaster course at DiveKomodo. We also recommend you read our reviews on Tripadvisor and check us out on Facebook, Instagram and our website.

For any questions do not hesitate to contact us. Hope to hear from you soon!

The DiveKomodo Team



+62 8113 813 591

www.divekomodo.com

divekomodolbj@gmail.com



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COURSE INTRO

The Divemaster course is the first step on PADI's professional ladder. It differs from the previous PADI courses because it is designed like an internship; you will gain experience by working alongside the team and represent the company in front of our guests. The days are typically long and are often both physically and mentally demanding; but at the same time rewarding and a lot of fun!

To give you thorough training the course with DiveKomodo is six weeks long, which is two weeks longer than what is the norm in most areas. You will have one main instructor in charge of your training progress as well as the chance to work with our other Instructors and Divemasters so that you learn different styles of dive leadership. We have a maximum of two DM trainees per instructor at a time to provide personal attention and offer an amazing experience that caters to your personal needs.

Your main work space will be our day boats and your duties will include logistics, customer service and various dive activities. You will join at least one liveaboard trip to gain a different experience and learn how to lead night dives.

There will be some theory days and visits to a local beach/pool for training and swim tests. To fully prepare you to find Divemaster employment you will also get involved in several other areas of the business including equipment repairs, selling courses and other trips, and checking guests in at the office.

To top it all off we will have a couple of activities in town for you to get in contact with local community and environmental initiatives.



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ABOUT DIVEKOMODO

We are a PADI 5 star training center and one of the first dive operators to open in the town of Labuan Bajo. Our team currently consists of 20 locals, with most of them born and raised on Flores island, and two foreigners. Most of us have worked at DiveKomodo for many years and our low staff-turnover shows that we are in a happy work environment.

Our dive leaders have many thousands of dives in Komodo and are specialists when it comes to diving with currents. We have operated in this area since 1996 and are proud to have a 100% clean safety record!

We take environmental protection seriously which reflects in the way we dive and how we run our operation.

We look for Divemaster trainees that fit in with our way of working together. A positive attitude is key and is a great combination with experience/willingness to understand the local culture.



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PARTNERSHIPS AND FRIENDS

We are happy to have the opportunity to partner up with some of our friends to collaborate on various sustainable tourism practice projects. Here are the one's we work with on a regular basis.

MantaWatch - over the years we have trained their interns how to dive and facilitated numerous research trips in Komodo National Park.

Trash Hero Komodo – we frequently help to arrange and sponsor regular activities including cleanups, kids' education, awareness events and water refill program.

DOCK – we co-founded this dive association in 2008 for dive operators practising sustainable tourism. Over the years we have run various projects such as installing moorings, creating local guidelines for safe/environmental diving practices and help reporting illegal activity in the park.

WWF Indonesia – we are a member of their program 'Signing Blue' and are annually assessed on our commitment on environmental protection, respect of local culture and support of local economy. We are currently working on our 4th "starfish".



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KOMODO NATIONAL PARK

Komodo National Park is located between the islands of Sumbawa and Flores. The town of Labuan Bajo on Flores is the gateway for visitors to the park. All our trips start, and end, here and the boarder of the park takes around 1,5 hour to reach.

The Park contains 100 islands including Komodo island and Rinca island which are home to the legendary Komodo dragons and several communities of seafarers. Komodo National Park is an UNESCO World Heritage Site and one of the New 7 Wonders of Nature,

The area is part of the Coral Triangle, meaning that the biodiversity for fish, invertebrates and corals are among the highest in the world! We frequently see big marine life such as mantas, sharks and turtles and occasionally get a visit from dolphins, whales and dugongs. We have a huge range of both pelagic and reef fish that we encounter daily.

The macro life is incredible too, with many species not yet scientifically identified. You will learn the tricks of the trade on how to find nudibranchs, ghost pipefish, pygmy seahorses, frogfish, octopus and much more to show your guests. Each dive site here is unique in terms of topography and the way of diving. Our sites include drift, pinnacles, walls, swim throughs, macro, protected bays, and manta "cleaning stations".



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SEASONS AND CURRENTS

Komodo is one of the few places in the world where it is possible to dive all year round. DiveKomodo remains open even during the rainy season as most days the weather is good for diving. There is however a risk of strong winds between mid-January and early March.

This area is famous for strong currents, these are not related to the seasons but will always be stronger around full moon and new moon. Doing your DM here will give you skills that you would not gain in other locations around the world that lack currents. Our experienced dive team will teach you how to assess conditions and tailor your dive plans according to current direction, current strength and the guests' experience levels. Safety, Trust, and Quality are the most important characteristics and we guarantee to make your time unforgettable.

We promise that having done your Divemaster in Komodo will look impressive on our CV - so what are you waiting for?



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COURSE GOALS

Listed below are the PADI activities that we will cover during the DM course. Some of them are done once and some will be repeated to ensure that you master them. There is not a set schedule during the course as most activities need to be planned around our bookings and weather/currents. We ask you to be flexible for last minute changes in your plan, rest assured that your main instructor will ensure that you achieve all goals within the time frame.

PADI STANDARDS

Theory – study course manuals, watch course videos, knowledge reviews and exams

Water skills – 15min tread, 400m swim, 800m snorkel, 100m tired diver tow, equipment exchange

Diver rescue – recap of Rescue course & design a local Emergency Action Plan

Dive skills workshop – learn how to demonstrate 24 common skills

Practical Application – set up/manage dive site, underwater mapping, dive briefings, search & recovery, deep dive

DM conducted program workshops – conduct Scuba Review, conduct Skin Diver, assist Discover Scuba Diving, conduct Discover Local Diving

Practical Assessment – assist on Open Water course, assist on Advanced/Rescue course, lead certified divers

Professionalism criteria – assessment of your attitude, care for environment, understanding of DM role and appearance



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OTHER ACTIVITIES

Dive related

DiveKomodo has added additional content to the DM course to ensure you become equipped with all tools necessary to be employed as a DM:

Equipment repair & maintenance - learn how to ensure that the gear stays in good condition and how to fix basic problems

Selling trips - extend your skills in sales by learning what information to give to your customers, how to plan a dive program, paperwork and fitting gear properly

Liveaboard - join at least one of our trips to get experience in leading night dives and a different setup of logistics

Environment & Community

It's important for us to give back, thus we want our DM trainees to understand the importance of protecting the environment and working together with the local community and have therefore added following activities:

Cultural introduction - learn local etiquette and Indonesian key vocabulary

Trash Hero - join at least one cleanup and one environmental lesson for local kids

Underwater cleanup - learn how to arrange an underwater cleanup

Komodo National Park knowledge - study three books covering Park Management, Marine Life and Terrestrial Life. Join at least one dragon trek on Rinca island.

Marine life recording* - daily online reporting of key species sightings

*The Komodo National Park authorities have agreed to let our DM trainees enter the park for free in exchange for this data.



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DM COURSE REQUIREMENTS

Before starting the course you will need:

- to be 18 years of age
- physician's clearance (use PADI medical form)
- 40 logged dives
- PADI Advanced certification*
- PADI Rescue certification*
- EFR certification/renewal** no older than 24 months on day of DM graduation
- to have fairly good fitness and a positive attitude

*If your certification is not from PADI then please contact us to check

**Some other certifying agencies are also accepted, find a list here:

<http://www.emergencyfirstresponse.com/accrediting-organizations/>



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DIVE GEAR

You can either bring your own dive equipment or rent it from us. Required gear for your DMT is listed below. If you plan to look for DM work after the course, then we recommend that you purchase your own equipment. Let us know if you need help in selecting suitable gear. We are also able to extend our Bali supplier discounts for you.

Required

- dive computer
- compass
- reel
- DSMB (delayed surface marker buoy)
- knife or line cutter

Recommended

- underwater slate (A5 size or wrist mounted)

Included if you rent from us

- BCD
- regulator
- wetsuit - most use full length 3mm
- mask & snorkel
- fins suitable for currents (split fins are not)
- boots



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DM COURSE PRICES 2020

Dive Komodo Rates

1550 USD - PADI Divemaster course

150 USD - equipment rental*

PADI Rates (prices may change)

240 USD - PADI Crew Pak (this is the required study material)

235 AUD - application fee which you will pay directly to PADI after the course

Included

- lunch, snacks, refill water, hot drinks on our day boat trips
- liveaboard trip with meals, refill water, hot drinks (normally 175 USD /day)
- park fees (normally 275,000 IDR /day)
- 3 Electronic Komodo National Park manuals
- electronic Marine Life ID books
- 2 DiveKomodo tshirts (normally 22 USD)
- 1 Dive Komodo logbook (with a postcard for your grandma, so no excuses!)
- Trash Hero water refill bottle (normally 12 USD)
- discounts on other courses
- discounts for life on fun diving



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ADDITIONAL COURSES & FUN DIVES 2020

We offer our DM candidates discounts the following (IDR):

Standard courses

PADI Advanced Open Water - 2 days (5 dives): 4,950,000 (normally 5,500,000)

EFR (Emergency First Responder) - 1 day : 1,800,000 (normally 2,200,000)

PADI Rescue Diver - 3 days (no logged dives). 5,200,000 (normally 6,000,000)

Included in courses:

Scuba gear rental, lunch, snacks, water, hot drinks, PADI manual & certification

Specialty courses

We offer various PADI Specialties that can be baked into the DM course such as Drift, Deep (gives certification to 40m), Peak Performance Buoyancy, Night, Photography and Shark Awareness. The Emergency Oxygen Provider Specialty is recommended as it may be required in some countries/companies to be employed as a dive professional. Let us know if you want more details on any of the additional courses.

Fun diving.

You need a minimum of 40 logged dives to start your Divemaster course. We offer you a seriously good discount on our day boat before the course:

Day boat diving - (1 day with 3 dives): 500,000 (normally 1,800,000)



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ARRANGEMENTS IN TOWN

Accommodation

There are various types of accommodation available in town and usually the price matches the standard and the location. Expect the price to be higher the closer you live to the tourist main street Jl. Soekarno Hatta. We are happy to help you find something suitable for your budget and needs. Most expensive would usually be staying at a hotel (AC, TV, breakfast, etc), around 6,000,000 IDR per month. For a room in a furnished house-share expect around 2,500,000-3,500,000 IDR per month.

If you want to save money and you are not scared of living very basic (bucket + scoop shower, squat toilet, mattress on floor etc) then you may want to stay at a "kost" for around 1,000,000 IDR per month.

Transport

Around the main street you find most restaurants, cafes, supermarkets, some shopping, and night market. So if you live central then you might be able to walk everywhere. However if you choose to live a bit further away then you may want to rent a motorbike. Typically the monthly cost is 1,000,000 IDR per month for an automatic motorbike and around 700,000 IDR for a semi-automatic.

At most locations around town it is also easy to find motorbike taxis that charge 5,000-20,000 IDR. Colourful mini-vans also circle around the main streets which charge 5,000-10,000 IDR.



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OTHER CONSIDERATIONS

Visa

You need to ensure that you have a valid visa during the duration of your course. The paid VOA (visa on arrival) cost around 35 USD at the airport when you arrive in Indonesia. This 30 day visa can be extended another 30 days at the immigration office in Labuan Bajo. The extension can only be made one time in-country and cost around 355,000 IDR.

Note that there is also a free 30-day tourist VOA but that this is not extendable so you would need to leave the country after 30 days.

Insurance

We recommend DAN as your insurance provider. We can help you purchase short-term insurance at 40 USD per month or you can buy annual membership on DAN's website.

Phone & Internet

In town you can find many restaurants and cafes with free WiFi for their guests. The network has improved a lot over the years but we still have days when signal is not so good. The only local phone network operating here is Telkomsel. Our team mainly communicate using Whatsapp so getting a local number may not be necessary.



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